

BEYOND THE KINGDOM — Episode #0005: Media & Fan Layer

Companion to Script #BTK-0005 · Air Date: Friday, January 7, 2005

A second death. The FBI arrives. The truce holds, quietly. The world reacts from Friday morning to Saturday, the morning of Lamar Whitlock's funeral.

WBKG CHANNEL 8 ACTION NEWS — WBKG.com

Posted 6:58 a.m., Friday, January 7, 2005

BREAKING: Man found shot to death inside Southside check-cashing store

Police are investigating a fatal shooting at a check-cashing business on Metropolitan Parkway. The victim has been identified by family members as Earl "Big E" Tuggle, 51, the store's owner. His niece discovered his body when she arrived to open the store Friday morning.

This is a developing story. Refresh for updates.

Updated 11:40 a.m.: APD Chief Elxa Jackson announced Friday that the department's Blackwater Task Force will be commanded by Detective Jeremy Jackson. FBI agents were seen at the Metropolitan Parkway scene.

>> POLL: Should the FBI take over the Blackwater investigation?

Yes — 44% · No, let APD handle it — 31% · Leave Sovereign alone — 25%

(8,114 votes. This is not a scientific poll.)

THE ATLANTA SENTINEL — Saturday, January 8, 2005 · Weekend Edition · 75¢

FRONT PAGE

SECOND 'BLACKWATER' SLAYING; FBI JOINS PROBE

Check-cashing owner found dead with onyx coin; Chief names husband to lead task force

By Marcus Webb, Staff Writer

A Southside check-cashing store owner was found shot to death Friday morning, the second killing in five days in which the victim was reportedly found holding a black onyx coin associated with the Blackwater Syndicate.

Earl Tuggle, 51, owner of Big E's Check Cashing & Payday Loans on Metropolitan Parkway, was found by his niece shortly after 6 a.m. Police said he died of a single gunshot wound late Thursday night.

Neighbors said Tuggle had been paying "protection" to the Syndicate for years. "That coin sat on his counter like a sign," said one merchant. "Everybody knew nobody would touch his store." Asked why the Syndicate would kill a man it protected, the merchant shrugged. "They wouldn't. That's what's scaring people."

Special agents from the FBI's Atlanta Field Office were seen at the scene. A Bureau spokesman confirmed "an ongoing federal investigation into organized criminal activity in the Atlanta region" but declined to elaborate.

At a Friday news conference, Chief Elxa Jackson named Detective Jeremy Jackson, her husband, to command the department's Blackwater Task Force. Asked about nepotism, the Chief cited his clearance record and offered to "hire someone better" if one could be found, "and Detective Jackson can take out the trash for a week." (*Continued on A8*)

LAMAR WHITLOCK TO BE LAID TO REST TODAY

Service at 11 a.m., Greater Cascade Baptist

BUSINESS · D1

Friday's closing prices (publicly traded Donohue affiliates):

Ticker	Company	Close	Change
DFN	Donohue Financial	\$183.90	-1.0%
DNRG	Donohue Energy	\$96.60	-0.6%
DPHR	Donohue Pharmaceuticals	\$144.45	+0.2%
DTEC	Donohue Technologies	\$61.70	-0.6%

Donohue Financial shares slipped after reports that the FBI's Atlanta office is expanding an organized-crime probe. The company declined to comment.

LIVING · "BEHIND THE GATES" by Bernadette Sinclair

The Friday Night Nobody Will Talk About.

Darlings, I have been writing this column for thirty-one years, and I have never seen this.

At 7:00 PM Friday, **Silas Merriweather**, the West End's most distinguished undertaker, walked through the front door of **Dee's Kitchen** on Ralph David Abernathy Boulevard. Longtime West Enders tell me he had not set foot in that restaurant since **1975**.

The dining room went silent. The proprietress, the legendary **Dolores Whitfield**, looked up from the counter and said two words: "**Friday, Silas.**"

He took off his hat. He went into the back room. He stayed an hour and fifteen minutes. When he came out, a diner tells me, he was "laughing and full of pie."

I don't know what was said in that room. Nobody will tell me, and I have asked *everyone*. But I know this city, and I know that when those two sit down at the same table, the Southside can breathe again.

Also spotted: A certain **silver Aston Martin**, parked across the boulevard the whole time, its young driver eating fried chicken out of foil. Atlanta's richest bachelor, darlings, doing a Friday-night drive-through at Dee's like a regular citizen. How *democratic*.

CRESTWATCH — crestwatch.blogspot.com

"All the news the gates keep out."

Friday, January 07, 2005 — 11:52 PM

NIGHT TWO IN THE LIBRARY (AND A DOOR CLOSED "POLITELY")

- **The Chairman:** night two of seven. Our source says the lady of the house brought him *one* cup of tea at 9:31 PM. One cup. Not two. We know what that means.
- **The palazzo:** At 6:32 PM, a certain CEO asked her husband where his "**first shirt**" went. He said "the dry cleaner." The dry cleaner on Peachtree Battle closes at six. She closed her dressing-room door, and our source says she did it *politely*. CrestWatchers, a polite door is the loudest door there is.
- **Velvet:** A new DJ from Chicago played the warm-up set tonight at a club everybody knows belongs to a certain Donohue son who is "still in Miami." Rumor says the DJ's last name rhymes with "really." We're checking.
- **The DA:** At 8:50 PM, a security guard at the Fulton courthouse saw the District Attorney run through the lobby **barefoot**, with no coat, and drive off. Everything okay, Madam DA? We're worried about you.

Posted by CrestWatch at 11:52 PM · 176 comments

KingdomKween404 said... a POLITE door... natasha bullock is about to end somebody

PeachStateTea said... rhymes with really... SMILLEY?? a smilley DJing in a DONOHUE club???
i'm deceased

BuckheadBarbie said... the DA barefoot... that's scary. she's so young

ChiTownDiva said... leave that girl alone, she's doing the Lord's work with that cold case thing

"FIND DEE" — finddee.livejournal.com

Friday, January 7th, 2005 — 6:14 pm

Current mood: hopeful

Current music: Donny Hathaway, "A Song for You"

The DA's office called me at work today. Personally. Dee's case has an investigator now. Her name is Carla Mims, and she has twenty-two years with the GBI, and she's calling me Monday.

The DA sent a note. It said, "Every two weeks. Whether there's news or not. Like I promised."

I've been writing on this page every week for three years. I've written to the police and the mayor and the newspapers and a lady on the radio. Nobody ever wrote back.

Arianna Cummings wrote back.

She's twenty-two, like me. She broke a pen in her hand because she was so upset for us. Daddy said Dee used to do that when he was trying not to cry.

For the first time in three years, I believe somebody.

Thank you, Arianna. From me, and Mama, and Daddy, and Lyric.

And from Dee. Wherever he is.

Tags: dee, DA, carla mims, hope, thank you

61 comments

grady_nurse_lo (Loretta Divine): Monday. We'll be ready.

cascadecutz: Arianna Cummings for GOVERNOR

E.O.S.: This is the happiest I've seen you in three years. <3

spelman_sis_05: crying at my desk rn

BLACKPLANET FORUMS — Atlanta > Local News & Politics

Thread: SILAS WALKED INTO MAMA DEE'S. THE TRUCE IS BACK???

Started by **Mama_Deese_Biggest_Fan** — 01/07/2005 8:45 PM

Mama_Deese_Biggest_Fan: I WAS THERE. i was eating oxtails. silas merriweather walked in, took off his hat, and the whole restaurant went quiet like church. mama dee said "friday, silas." y'all i got CHILLS

WestEndWill: so it's over?? no war??

Mama_Deese_Biggest_Fan: they were in the back an hour. he came out LAUGHING. that's all i know

SouthsideSaint_78: word is both sides gonna be at lamar's funeral tomorrow. TOGETHER. outside the church

HonestAbe_ATL: two criminal organizations providing joint security at a funeral. what is happening to this city

ConspiracyKeith: i told y'all. somebody was trying to start a war. and they just figured it out. now whoever that somebody is better RUN

ATLien_4Life: keith being right two times in one week is scaring me more than the coins

AOL MESSAGE BOARDS — Local > Atlanta > Current Events

Subject: Chief puts her HUSBAND in charge of the task force

Posted by **GA_Taxpayer1952** — 1/7/05 12:02 PM

GA_Taxpayer1952: First the grandfather gets her the job. Now she gives her husband the biggest case in the city. When does the dog get a badge?

RetiredAPD_Sarge: Jeremy Jackson closed more homicides last year than any detective in that building. I trained his daddy. The boy's the real deal.

FultonDem_Daryl: "Detective Jackson can take out the trash for a week." I laughed out loud. She's good at this.

GA_Taxpayer1952: Being good at press conferences isn't the same as being good at police work.

RetiredAPD_Sarge: She's good at both. That's what makes the old boys nervous.

MYSPEACE BULLETINS

From: Q IN THE ATL — Jan 8 2005 1:12 AM

Subject: first night in the ATL booth

Warm-up set at Velvet tonight. Club manager said "don't play anything anybody knows," so I played Chicago house for two hours and made 300 people who didn't come to dance... dance. You're welcome, Atlanta. Back next week. And no, I'm not telling y'all my last name.

AIM AWAY MESSAGES (Friday night)

SaintsCarWash: rest easy big e. we got the babies. we got em forever.

KiaraB_BCA: amond came home at 9:30 smelling like fried chicken and wouldn't say where from

MalloryO_Spelman: ONE drop of vetiver. and alexander can hush.

jjackson_apd: commander. (still taking out the trash)

CeleVaughnWBKG: counting.

ghost_000: 7 of 11 left.

End of Media & Fan Layer, Episode #0005. Continued with Episode #0006 (Monday, January 10, 2005).